

Delivering UConn Nutrition Counseling Sessions

 Role: Registered Dietitian  Version 0.1 (draft)  Reviewed May 2026

 **Draft — example content pending clinical review and sign-off. Do not use for training or to guide care until approved.**

This procedure covers how you, as a registered dietitian, deliver the UConn pilot's nutrition counseling sessions — running each session, capturing encounter notes in Athena, and reviewing the participant's care plan and outcomes in the Cena platform.

Scope

What this role covers, and where its boundaries are.

For	Registered dietitians delivering counseling sessions for the UConn Health food-as-medicine pilot.
Covers	Delivering the five counseling sessions (Months 0, 2, 4, 6, 9), capturing encounter notes in Athena, and reviewing each participant's care plan and outcomes in the Cena platform.
Does not cover	Weekly care-coordination check-ins, contact logging, or appointment booking (the care coordinator's role). Scheduling is handled in Athena by the care coordinator.

Each counseling session

The same flow for every session in the schedule. Notes live in Athena; the care plan lives in Cena.

1

Deliver the counseling session

- In person for the first session; later sessions follow the Month 0 / 2 / 4 / 6 / 9 schedule.
- ✓ A completed counseling encounter for the participant.
- i The contract allows sessions 2–5 to be remote, but Cena committed to all-in-person; deliver in person unless this has been reconciled with UConn.

2

Capture your encounter notes in Athena

- In Athena, on the participant's encounter — use the quick-snippet pick-lists for fluid note-taking.
- ✓ Notes saved to the billable encounter in Athena.
- i Athena is the system of record for billable encounters — do not re-enter notes into Cena. Cena pulls them from Athena and files them on the patient record for you.

3

Review the care plan and outcomes in Cena

- In the Cena platform, on the participant's detail view.
- ✓ The care plan reflects the latest session and the participant's current outcomes.
- i Patient-experience data — food preferences and care-plan changes — lives in Cena, not Athena.

Where things go

Two routing decisions that come up every session — session modality, and which system holds which data.

SESSION MODALITY

 The first session (Month 0)	➔ Always in person — the contract requires it.
 Sessions 2–5	➔ In person by default (Cena's commitment). If remote is needed, reconcile with UConn before scheduling.

WHICH SYSTEM HOLDS THE DATA

 Billable encounter content	➔ Athena — the system of record for anything coded for reimbursement.
 Patient-experience data	➔ Cena — food preferences, care-plan iteration, and custom outcomes.

Quick reference

The session flow, condensed to a tickable list.

Every counseling session

- ☐ Confirm the session modality (session 1 in person; later sessions in person by default)
- ☐ Deliver the counseling session
- ☐ Capture encounter notes in Athena (not Cena)
- ☐ Review the care plan and outcomes in Cena

Terms used in this SOP

Plain-language definitions, no system jargon.

Encounter	A single counseling session with a participant, recorded for billing.
Athena	The system where encounters are recorded and coded for reimbursement. It is the official record for billable visit content.
Care plan	The participant's nutrition plan in Cena — it updates as you learn more across sessions.
Quick snippets	Athena's pick-list shortcuts for common note text, so you can capture notes during the session.
Patient-experience data	What lives in Cena rather than Athena — food preferences, care-plan changes, and custom outcomes.

Sign-off

An RD SOP clears more than one gate. It is approved for training only when all of

them are signed.



Sign-off

- Clinically accurate — clinical lead
- Operationally true — Vanessa Sena
- Signed off — Director of Clinical Ops

Awaiting all gates – draft, not yet approved for training

Version 0.1